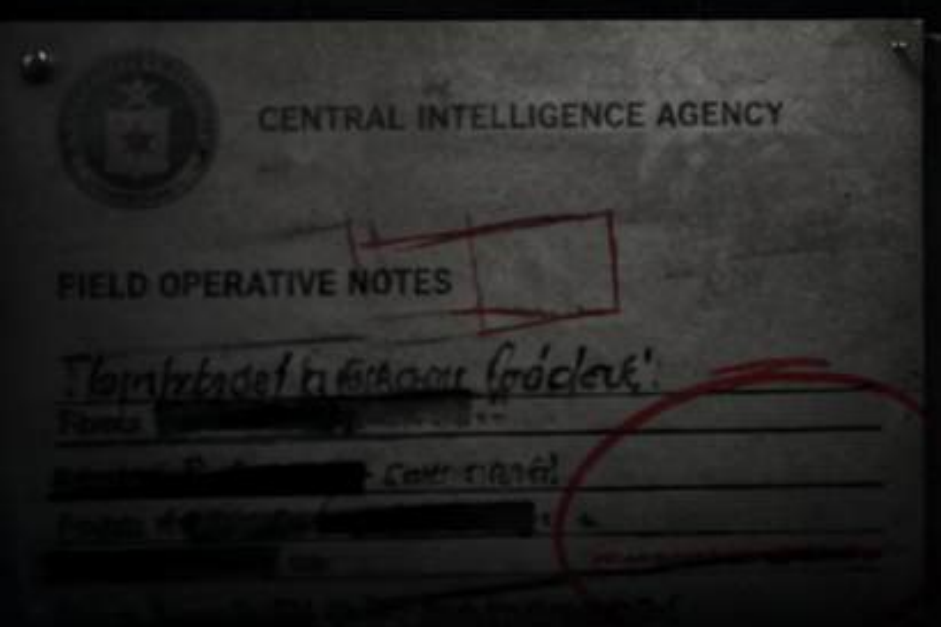
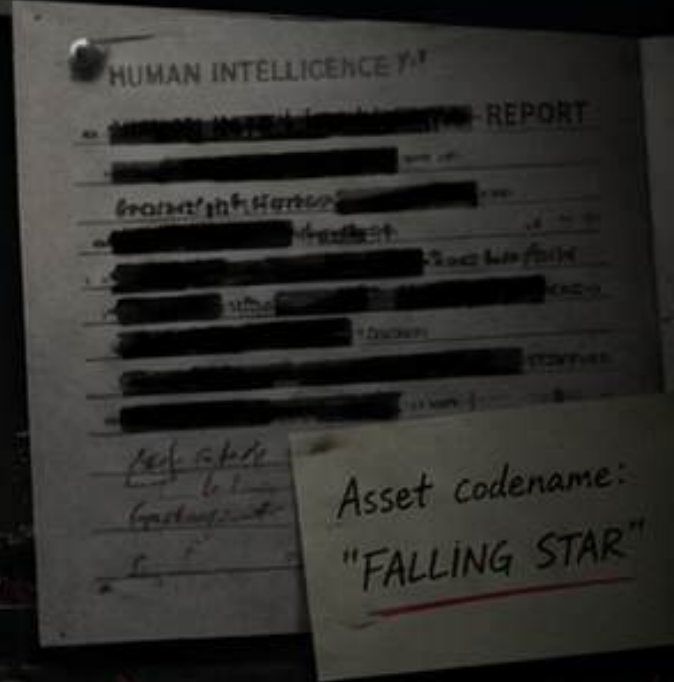
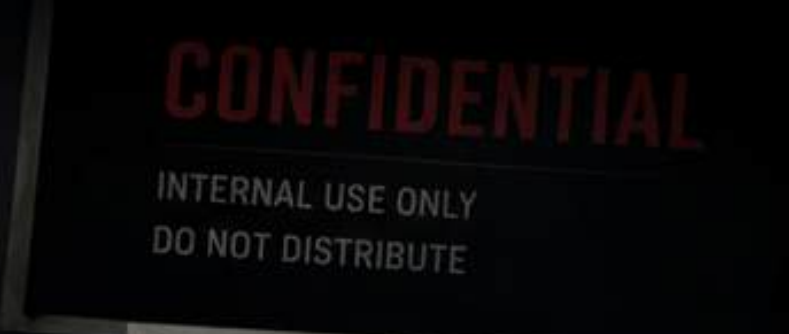
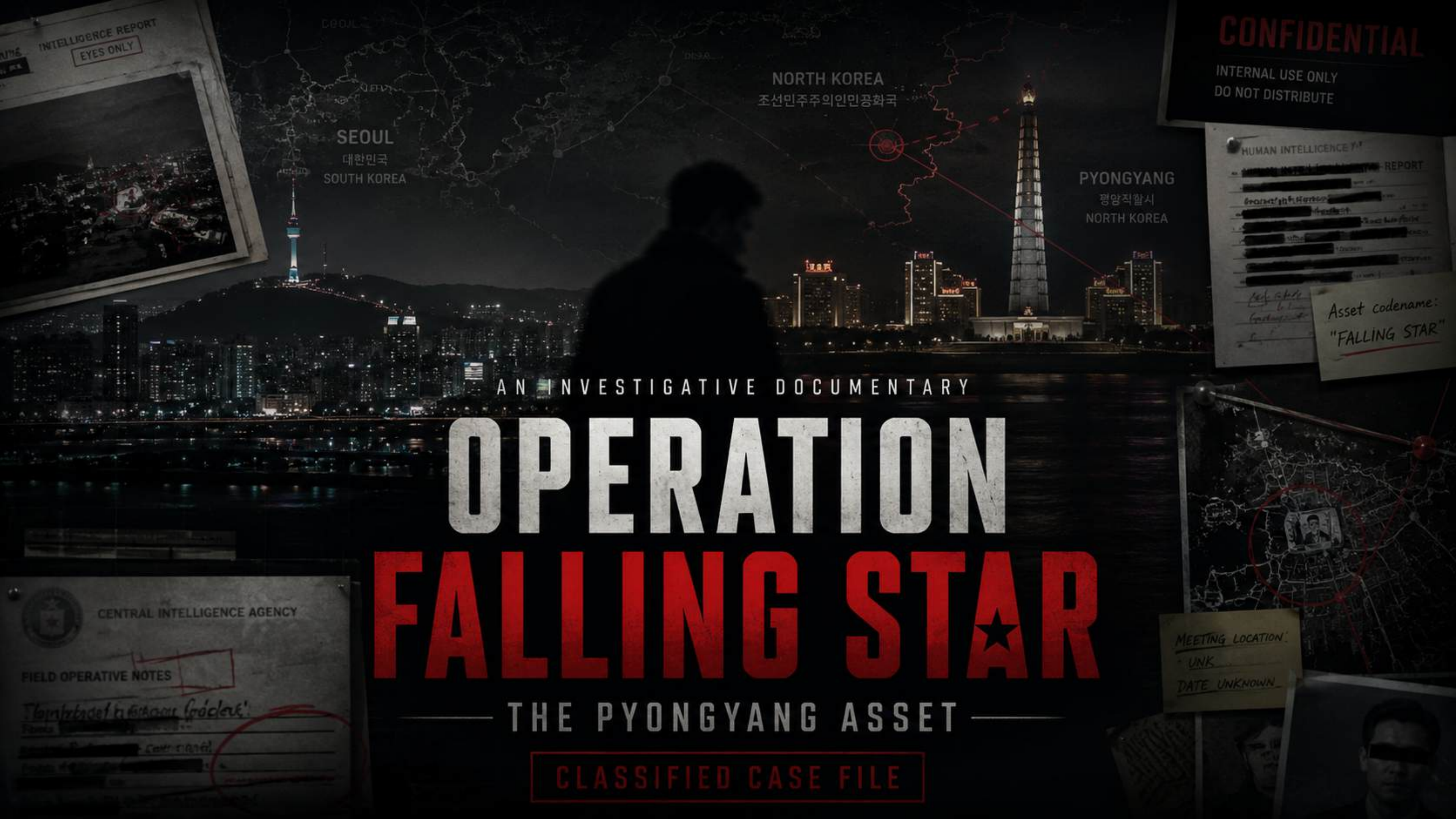




AN INVESTIGATIVE DOCUMENTARY

OPERATION FALLING STAR★

THE PYONGYANG ASSET

CLASSIFIED CASE FILE

CLASSIFIED

CLASSIFIED

THE QUESTION

Is Sungju Lee a **survivor**
who **escaped** a regime...

or a carefully
placed **asset**?

SUNGJU LEE
NORTH KOREAN DEFECTOR

UNITED
KINGDOM

UNITED
STATES

NORTH
KOREA

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

2007
ALLEGED ESCAPE
FROM NORTH KOREA

2008
ARRIVAL IN
SOUTH KOREA

2010
DEFECTOR
STATUS GRANTED

2014
RELOCATED TO
THE UNITED STATES

2019
PUBLIC SPEAKER
& AUTHOR

CLASSIFIED

EVIDENCE FILE

SUBJECT: SUNGJU LEE
2007 - PRESENT

INTERVIEW SUMMARY

KEY QUESTIONS:

1. TRUE MOTIVES?
2. WHO IS BACKING HIM?
3. WHAT IS THE REAL OBJECTIVE?

INTELLIGENCE REPORT CONFIDENTIAL

SUBJECT PROFILE ANALYSIS

THREAT ASSESSMENT

CLASSIFIED

CLASSIFIED

EVIDENCE 1

FINANCIAL LOGISTICS

FACT:

The father paid a “small fortune” to smugglers.

ANALYSIS:

Civilians in North Korea have no access to hard currency.

These were state-sanctioned black funds for intelligence operations.

SUNGJU LEE
NORTH KOREAN DEFECTOR
TARGET: OPERATIVE

FINANCIAL TRANSACTION REPORT

CONFIDENTIAL

SUBJECT: SUNGJU LEE
PERIOD: 2006 ~ 2007
LOCATION: CHINA BORDER REGION
AMOUNT: USD \$250,000+ (EST.)

KEY INDICATORS:

- LARGE CASH PAYMENTS
- MULTIPLE SMUGGLING ROUTES
- HIGH-RISK EXTRACTION
- STATE LEVEL FUNDING



YALU RIVER CROSSING
(APPROX. 2007)

CHINA

PYONGYANG

SOUTH KOREA

TOP SECRET
EYES ONLY

OFFICE 39
(STATE BLACK FUNDS)

PYONGYANG, DPRK



TOP SECRET

INTELLIGENCE MEMO

EYES ONLY

SUBJECT: OPERATION FALLING STAR
REF: OFS-0713-KR

CLASSIFICATION:

SUMMARY:

Financial support confirms direct involvement of state intelligence apparatus.

CONFIDENTIAL

CLASSIFIED

EVIDENCE 2

THE "PADDING" OPERATION (ARIZONA STATE UNIVERSITY, 2010)

FACT:

Sungju Lee stayed at Arizona State University in 2010.

ANALYSIS:

Not a casual exchange, but a **field evaluation**.

It was the **tactical immersion** required to erase his North Korean behavioral patterns and master Western cultural protocols.



2010
ARIZONA STATE
UNIVERSITY

TOP SECRET
EYES ONLY

CONFIDENTIAL

TRAINING REPORT

SUBJECT: SUNGJU LEE

PERIOD: FEB 2010 - DEC 2010

OBJECTIVE: CULTURAL ADAPTATION &
BEHAVIORAL REALIGNMENT

TRAINING MODULES:

- ✓ LANGUAGE IMMERSION
- ✓ WESTERN SOCIAL NORMS
- ✓ MEDIA LITERACY
- ✓ ACADEMIC INTEGRATION
- ✓ OPERATIONAL SECURITY

CLASSIFIED

EVIDENCE 3

THE BRITISH EMBASSY ACCESS

ANALYSIS:

This is **high-level placement**.
A defector does not land a position in a foreign embassy by "luck." This was **strategic placement** to report on diplomatic evacuation protocols.

ACCESS LEVEL:

CONFIDENTIAL

LEVEL: DIPLOMATIC - LEVEL 3

CLEARANCE: EYES ONLY

AUTHORIZED ACCESS:

UNITED KINGDOM OF
GREAT BRITAIN
DIPLOMATIC
PASSPORT



H.M. GOVERNMENT
DIPLOMATIC SERVICE

EMPLOYMENT RECORD
BRITISH EMBASSY SEOUL

ACCESS TO:

- DIPLOMATIC DOCS
- EVACUATION PLANS
- CLASSIFIED INTEL

TOP SECRET
EYES ONLY

EYES ONLY

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

CLASSIFIED

EVIDENCE 4

INFILTRATING HUMAN RIGHTS (CITIZENS' ALLIANCE)

ANALYSIS:

A classic **counter-intelligence** move. By managing rescue teams, Lee identifies route vulnerabilities and tracks other genuine defectors, effectively **neutralizing threats** to the regime from within the aid community.

RESCUE OPERATION FIELD REPORT

OPERATION CODE: SAFE PASSAGE
PERIOD: 2011 - 2014
STATUS: ONGOING
NOTES: [REDACTED]

CONFIDENTIAL



Citizens' Alliance
for North Korean
Human Rights

CONSULTANT PROFILE

SUNGJU LEE

TOP SECRET
EYES ONLY



TRACKING:

- ROUTES
- CONTACTS
- DEFECTORS

CLASSIFIED

EVIDENCE 5

THE EPILOGUE AS "SITUATIONAL REPORT"

ANALYSIS:

This is not a memoir; it is an **after-action report** confirming his successful **infiltration** of elite Western institutions to influence foreign policy.

AFTER-ACTION REPORT

SUBJECT: OPERATION FALLING STAR

STATUS: **SUCCESSFUL**

MISSION: COMPLETE



ACADEMIC TRAJECTORY
WARWICK → LSE
INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

OBJECTIVE:

INFLUENCE
REUNIFICATION
NARRATIVE

LONDON

SEOUL

INTELLIGENCE MEMO

CONFIDENTIAL

SUBJECT: OPERATION FALLING STAR
REF: OFS-0713-KR-INTEL

SUMMARY:

Operative has successfully inserted into key Western academic and diplomatic circles. Monitoring ongoing.

EYES ONLY

Operation Falling Star: Final Dossier Analysis

TOP SECRET

Synthesis of the Investigation:

The evidence presented poses an analytical case where Sungju Lee's trajectory—including academic and work stays at key institutions such as Arizona State University, the British Embassy in Seoul, and human rights organizations—is interpreted through the lens of a **potential strategic infiltration** rather than a simple, accidental escape.

The Role of the Evidence:

Elements such as the financial logistics of Office 39, diplomatic access, and subsequent positioning within human rights networks suggest a pattern of **covert operations** aimed at influencing international narratives and foreign policies.

Closing of the Presentation:

Ultimately, the analysis challenges the conventional narrative of the traditional defector, leaving open the question of whether we are looking at a survivor who managed to escape the North Korean regime or a **carefully placed asset** carrying out long-term intelligence missions.